SOUNDSCAPE OF IRAN

صحنهٔ صدای ایران

If the exhibition is about sound, the poster should look like the machine that makes it.

EXHIBITION
Karestan Building, Tehran

DATES
10 January – 7 February 2025

SUPPORTED BY
Divar

MY WORK
Poster · illustration family · social media



02 — BEFORE YOU BEGIN

ONE POSTER, A WHOLE MACHINE

Soundscape of Iran was a sound exhibition in a historic Tehran house. This file starts with that place and its story, takes the poster apart piece by piece, then follows its parts as they became illustrations, social posts and posters on the city's walls.

Persian with English
Persian text from the work is followed by an English translation.

Numbered markers
Red dots on an image match the notes beside it.

Mine and theirs
Exhibition photos are the project's own documentation; the drawings are mine.

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THE POSTER

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03 — THE HOUSE AND THE VOICE

A SINGER'S HOUSE FULL OF SOUND

The exhibition took place in a 113-year-old house that had belonged to an opera singer. The brief was not just an event poster: it had to carry the idea of sound — and of a building where Iranian music history had lived.

1937	Fakhereh Saba leaves for France to study opera; she becomes one of the first Iranian women opera singers and performs at Roudaki Hall.
~40 yrs	The Karestan building on Khark Street is her home.
2017	Divar restores the empty, abandoned house and gives it back its cultural identity.
2025	The exhibition, a tribute to her, lets visitors hear the first sounds recorded in Iran through interactive devices. Entry is free.

Facts from the exhibition's launch carousel (board 10).



Fakhereh Saba



The Karestan door

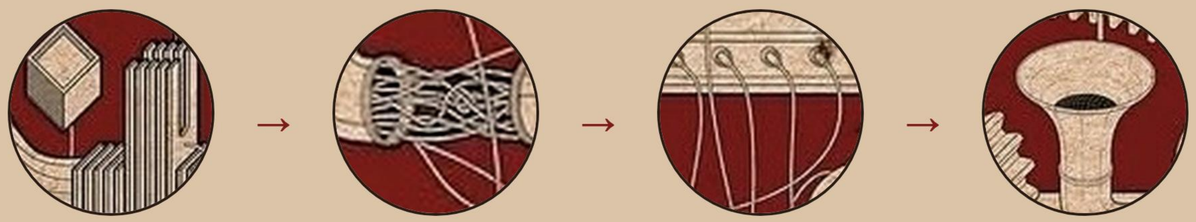


Inside the exhibition

04 — THE IDEA

IF IT'S ABOUT SOUND, DRAW THE MACHINE

Sound can't be printed. So instead of picturing a speaker or a sound wave, the poster shows the thing in between: a contraption that sound runs through — from source, along pipes and wires, out of a horn — with the exhibition's own name as its body.





01

LETTERS AS APPARATUS

The Persian title is not typeset — it is assembled from pipes, horns, cables and gears, so the words look like something sound could travel through.

02

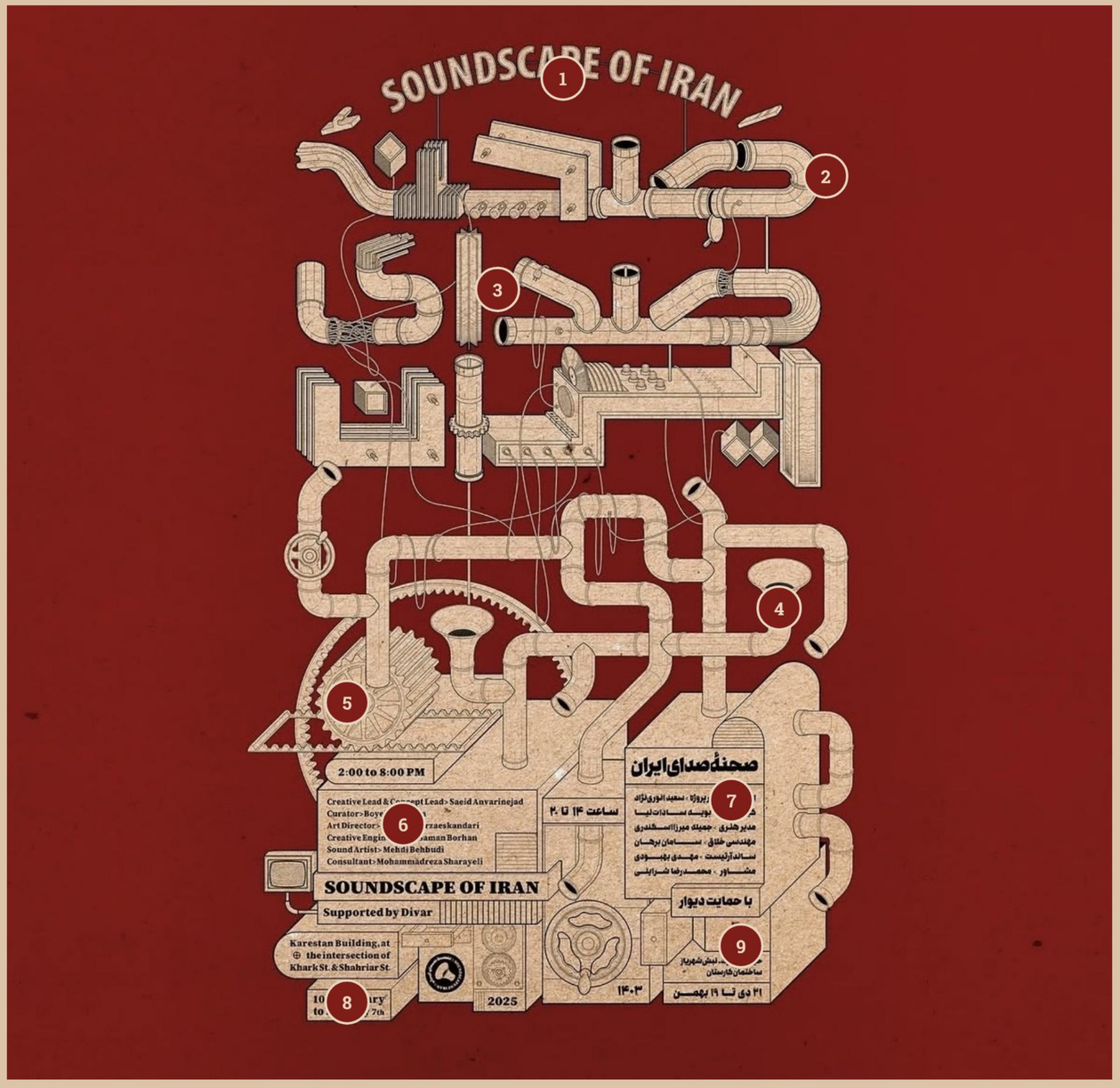
INFORMATION INSIDE THE MACHINE

Dates, times, credits and the address sit in the machine's own boxes and panels, in Persian and English, instead of being laid on top.

03

A PRINTED TECHNICAL DRAWING

Kraft-paper texture, fine black outlines and a muted red ground give it the feel of an old engineering print.



05 — ANATOMY

READ IT TOP TO BOTTOM

1 English arc
The name in English, bent like a sign over a workshop door.

2 Persian title
صحنهٔ صدای ایران — three lines lettered from pipes.

3 Cables
Wires hang from letter to letter, as if the title were wired up.

4 The machine
The title runs down into pipes and horns that fill the poster.

5 Gear
A large gear anchors the left side — the mechanism turning.

6 English panel
Time, credits and title in a slab serif, inside a box of the machine.

7 Persian panel
The same information in Persian, in a box of its own — two languages, equal weight.

8 Footer blocks
Venue and dates in both calendars, stacked like crates.

9 Sponsor
Divar's red wordmark — the only colour on the kraft parts.



صحنهٔ — صدای — ایران

Sahneh-ye Sedā-ye Irān · “The Soundscape of Iran”

06 — LETTERING

EVERY STROKE IS A PART

Persian letters are built from joined curves and dots. Each of those features was swapped for a mechanical part that does the same job, so the title still reads — but as hardware.

1. **Dot → cube**
   A small cube sits where a letter's dot would be.
2. **Terminal → open pipe**
   Strokes end in pipe mouths, as if sound comes out of the letter.
3. **Curve → elbow**
   Round letter bowls are drawn as pipe elbows and bends.
4. **Thick stroke → stacked plates**
   Heavy verticals are layered plates, like a speaker's laminations.
5. **Joint → coupling**
   Where strokes meet, a mesh coupling joins two pipes.
6. **Link → cable**
   Thin cables tie the three words into one circuit.
7. **Bowl → record player**
   Inside ایران, a stack of records and knobs takes the place of a letter body.
8. **Two dots → two cubes**
   The two dots under ی become a pair of cubes.

07 — KIT OF PARTS

TEN PARTS, ONE MACHINE

Everything in the identity — poster, emblems, social posts — is assembled from the same small set of parts, all drawn in the same isometric line style. That is what makes it a system rather than one image.



01 Open pipe



02 Horn



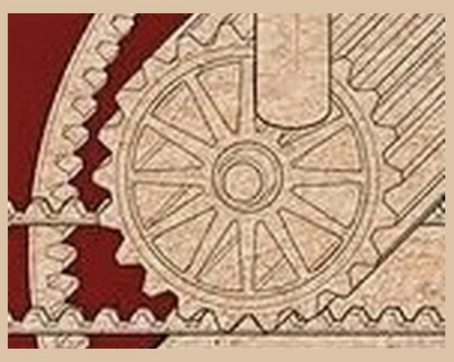
03 Mesh coupling



04 Plates & cube



05 Cables



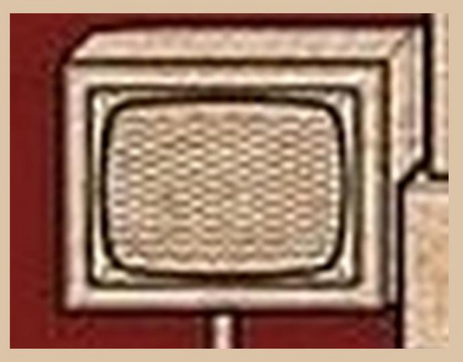
06 Gear & rack



07 Valve wheel



08 Records & knobs



09 Screen



10 Hand wheel

08 — COLOUR & PAPER

RED, KRAFT AND INK

A muted red, the brown of kraft paper and a dark ink outline — the palette of an old printed technical drawing. The paper grain is kept in every part, so even on screen the work looks printed.

SIGNAL RED

#7F1E18
Ground

KRAFT

#D9BEA3
Parts and paper

INK

#2A1C14
Outlines

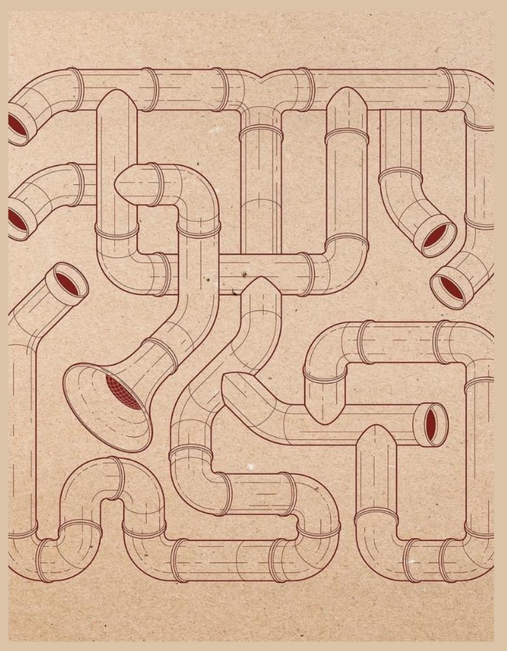
BLACK

#0B0B0B
Night variant

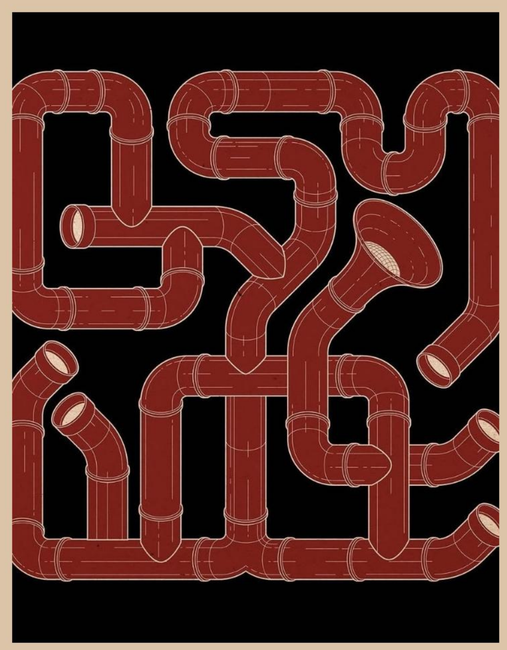
ONE DRAWING, THREE COLOURWAYS



Kraft on red — the main pairing



Red on kraft — the reverse

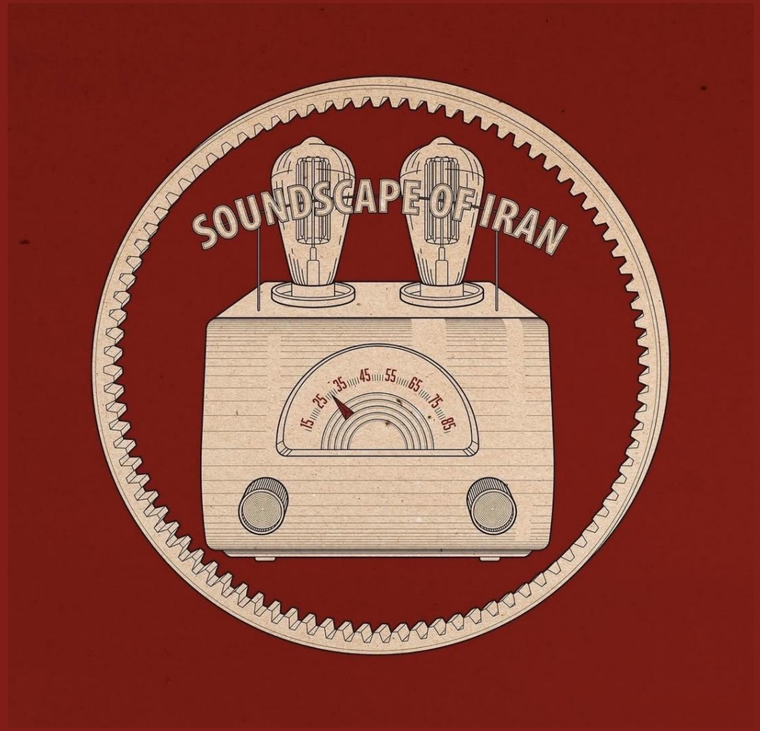


Red on black — for night and screens

09 — ILLUSTRATION FAMILY

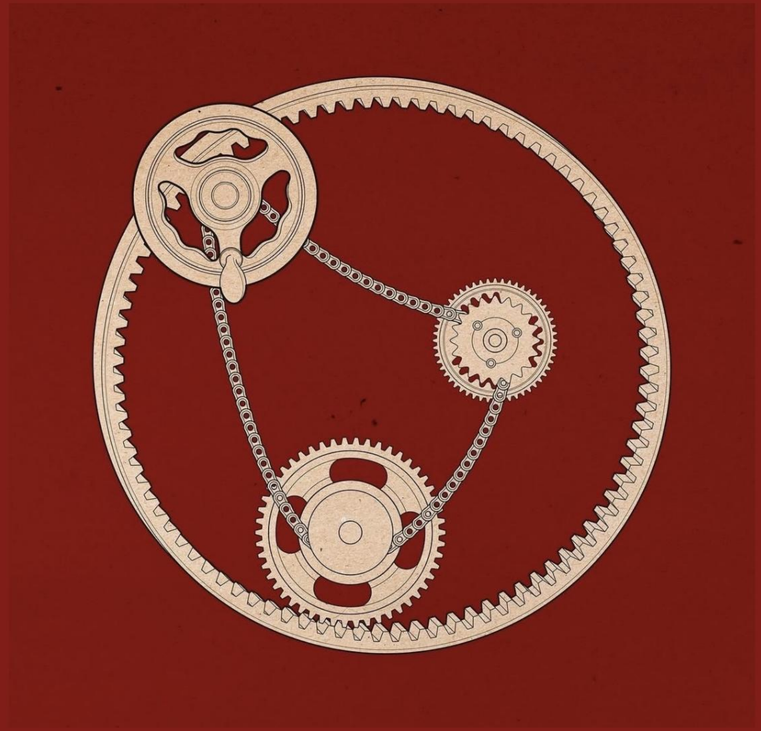
THE PARTS, SET FREE

The poster's parts were rebuilt as stand-alone square images for social media and print. Each one is circular or square, so it works as an emblem, a profile picture or a sticker.



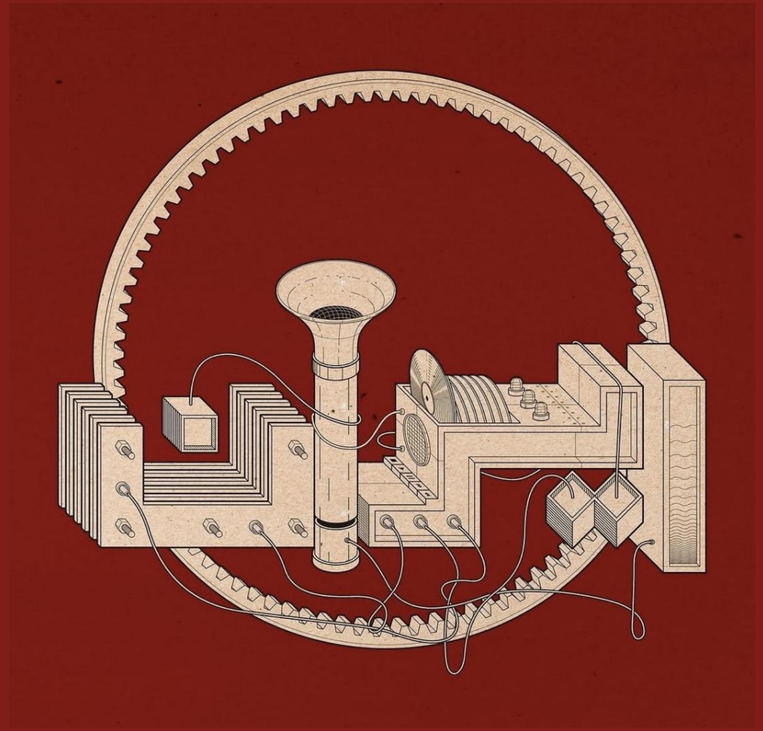
RADIO EMBLEM

A valve radio with the English name wired between its tubes, framed by a ring gear.



GEAR TRAIN

A hand crank driving two gears by chain inside the same ring — the motion behind the sound.



SOUND MACHINE

The word ایران rebuilt as a machine with a horn, records and a speaker grille.

10 — LAUNCH CAROUSEL

FIVE SLIDES, ONE STORY

A joint post with Divar introduced the exhibition. Each slide frames a photo or line of text in an arch-and-panel drawing that echoes the house's own doorway, so the story — sponsor, venue, singer, restoration, invitation — reads as one piece.



1 / 5

Divar — for bringing back to life. Divar — sponsor of the Soundscape of Iran exhibition.



2 / 5

Divar is holding the exhibition in a historic house tied to part of Iran's music history; here the first sounds recorded in Iran can be heard through creative interactive devices.



3 / 5

The Karestan building on Khark Street was for nearly four decades the home of Fakhereh Saba, who went to France in 1937 to study opera and became one of the first Iranian women opera singers.



4 / 5

In 2017 Divar restored this empty, abandoned house and gave it back its cultural identity.



5 / 5

The exhibition is a tribute to Fakhereh Saba, former resident of the Karestan building. Open until 7 February, free to the public.

REACH 1,152 likes · 20 comments · 129 shares on the joint post with Divar

11 — SOCIAL POSTS

A CARD FOR EVERY DEVICE

The exhibition's interactive sound devices each got their own animated title card: the device's invented Persian name, lettered in heavy kraft type with a 3D shadow, inside a drawn frame of circles, boxes and borders.

Around them, posts reuse the kit of parts — a date stamp made of gears, the house drawn as an elevation, the machine in isometric — so the feed reads as one identity.

DEVICE TITLE CARDS



Gush-bin



Aldang



Kaman-reil



Qoliz



Kanjeh



Mowj-negar



Lulhang

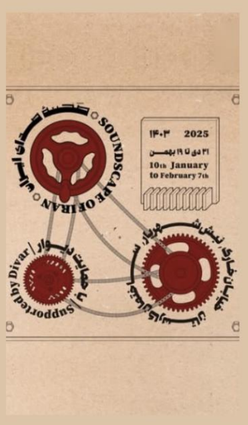


Sheshkast

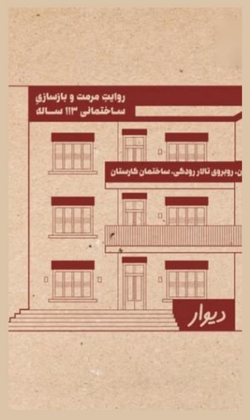


Delshodegan

IDENTITY POSTS



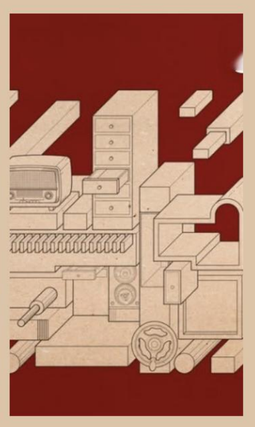
Date stamp

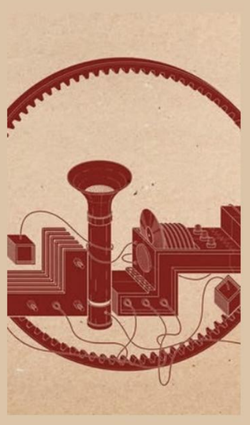


The 113-year-old house



Machine with name


Parts in isometric


Ring-gear emblem



Horn stamp



Street wall



Shop shutter



Among other cultural posters

12 — IN THE CITY

PRINTED AND POSTED

The poster was printed and pasted around Tehran — on white walls, metal shutters and crowded noticeboards. Against busy, colourful neighbours, one dense machine on a flat red ground still stands out from across the street.

13 — IN THE SPACE

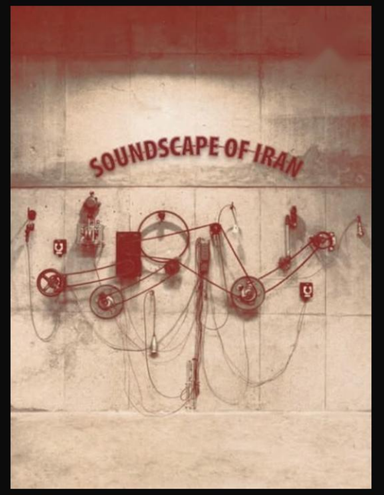
THE MACHINE, BUILT FOR REAL

Inside the house, the exhibition used real pipes, horns and wires on bare concrete. Visitors put their ears to pipe mouths to hear the first sounds recorded in Iran — the same parts the poster is lettered from.

Photos: the exhibition's own documentation, from its Instagram.



The poster at the entrance



Wall installation



Listening at a pipe



Pipes on concrete



Original records



The room of cabinets



Visitors



Opening

14 — CREDITS

SOUNDSCAPE OF IRAN

MY WORK

Poster design, illustration family and social media posts



EXHIBITION TEAM, AS CREDITED ON THE POSTER

CREATIVE LEAD & CONCEPT LEAD	Saeid Anvarinejad
CURATOR	Boyeh Sadatnia
ART DIRECTOR	Jamileh Mirzaeskandari
CREATIVE ENGINEERING	Saman Borhan
SOUND ARTIST	Mehdi Behbudi
CONSULTANT	Mohammadreza Sharayeli

Supported by Divar · Karestan Building, Khark St. & Shahriar St., Tehran · 10 Jan – 7 Feb 2025

CONCEPT

One idea — the poster as the machine that makes the sound — carried through every piece.

LETTERING

A Persian title built from mechanical parts that still reads at a distance.

BILINGUAL LAYOUT

Persian and English given equal weight inside the illustration.

SYSTEM

A kit of parts that extends from poster to emblems, social cards and the street.